WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

GUYANA

Americas

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Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Georgetown	Capital, main port and commercial centre, linked to the west bank by the new four-lane Demerara River Bridge opened in October 2025	Construction, real estate, hospitality, financial and professional services
Stabroek Block (offshore)	Engine of national growth, producing around 900,000 barrels a day, with the 250,000-barrel-a-day Uaru project due on stream from Q4 2026 and capacity targeted at 1.7 million barrels a day by 2030	Oil and gas, offshore services, logistics, supply chain
Wales (West Bank Demerara)	Site of the 300 MW gas-to-energy power plant and natural gas liquids facility, on track for completion by end-2026, and a planned industrial zone	Power generation, gas processing, manufacturing
Berbice (east)	Agricultural heartland for sugar and rice, with sugar output up 19.3% in H1 2026, and a growing location for port and shore-base development	Agro-processing, sugar, rice, port logistics
Linden	Bauxite mining town and gateway to the interior road network	Bauxite, mining services, transport
Lethem (Brazil border)	Southern gateway to northern Brazil, where the government is considering Guyana's first free trade zone	Cross-border trade, logistics, agriculture
Interior mining districts	Gold and diamond-producing regions, with gold output up 11.3% in H1 2026	Gold mining, mining services, forestry

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Guyana Office for Investment (GO-Invest), the national investment promotion agency, which assists with business registration, tax-concession applications, investment agreements and land applications
- Investment Act 2004, which bars discrimination between foreign and domestic investors and provides for tax holidays, exemptions, accelerated depreciation and repatriation of capital, profits and dividends
- Local Content Act 2021, overseen by the Local Content Secretariat, which reserves 40 categories of oil and gas goods and services for qualifying Guyanese firms and makes joint ventures a natural entry route
- Planned industrial and free zones, including the Wales development area beside the gas-to-energy project and a proposed free trade zone at Lethem on the Brazilian border

- Bank of Guyana currency regime: the Guyana dollar is legally convertible at an official rate held near G$208.5 per $1, with invoice verification for conversions since September 2025, so US-dollar access should be planned with banks in advance
- Oil and gas participation through the Ministry of Natural Resources and the supply chains of the Stabroek operators (ExxonMobil, Chevron and CNOOC)
- International dispute protection through ICSID membership, the New York Convention (in force since 2014) and the Caribbean Court of Justice as final court of appeal

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Guyana is the fastest-growing economy in the Americas and one of the fastest-growing in the world. Real GDP grew 19.3% in 2025, with the non-oil economy expanding by about 14%, and the government estimates growth of 33.3% in the first half of 2026, raising its full-year forecast to 20.8%, with non-oil growth of 10.2%. Oil output passed 900,000 barrels a day in late 2025, and the 250,000-barrel-a-day Uaru project, due to start in Q4 2026, is set to take production above one million barrels a day. Foreign direct investment reached about $9 billion in 2025, according to UNCTAD data. The IMF described the outlook as highly favourable in October 2026, with 2025 inflation at 3.3%, and still rates the risk of debt distress as low, with public debt at 28.9% of GDP at end-2025. The Natural Resource Fund held $4.29 billion at end-June 2026, and the PPP/C government's re-election with 36 of 65 seats in September 2025 gives policy continuity.

Guyana's main structural challenge is turning oil wealth into broad, lasting prosperity. Crude oil accounted for over 85% of export receipts in 2025, and rapid growth is putting pressure on power, housing, skills and US-dollar liquidity. The policy response is substantial. Oil revenues are saved and managed through the Natural Resource Fund. The 300 MW gas-to-energy project is designed to cut the cost of power for industry. Large public investment in roads and bridges is lifting non-oil sectors, with construction, manufacturing and agriculture leading growth. The IMF expects non-oil growth of about 7% a year over the next five years, and a larger share of oil income will flow to the Fund as cost recovery winds down. For investors, this is the core opportunity: supplying the infrastructure, services, food production and manufacturing that a fast-growing, newly wealthy economy needs.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Venezuela's claim to the Essequibo region	Venezuela claims around 70% of Guyana's territory, and there were border incidents in 2025. The International Court of Justice held hearings in May 2026, and a final, binding ruling is expected within months	Guyana is pursuing a legal resolution with broad international backing and closer US security cooperation; investors in western regions can use political-risk insurance, and a ruling would bring greater legal clarity
US-dollar availability and repatriation timing	Demand for foreign exchange exceeds local supply, and since September 2025 banks must verify invoices before converting currency. Investors report delays in repatriating profits	Agree conversion lead times with banks early, match dollar costs with dollar revenues where possible and set out repatriation terms in investment agreements
Concentration in oil	Crude oil accounted for over 85% of export receipts in 2025, so public revenues are linked to oil prices	The Natural Resource Fund ($4.29 billion at end-June 2026) and non-oil growth of about 10% are broadening the base, creating openings in agriculture, manufacturing and services
Infrastructure and skills capacity	Rapid growth is stretching power, transport, housing and the skilled labour supply	The 300 MW gas-to-energy plant, the new Demerara River Bridge and large road programmes are easing constraints, and each is itself a source of contracts and investment opportunities
Local content requirements	The Local Content Act reserves 40 categories of oil and gas work for qualifying Guyanese firms, with ownership and employment thresholds	Partner with Guyanese firms through joint ventures and register early with the Local Content Secretariat
Commercial court capacity	The commercial court has a single judge and a case backlog, which can slow	Build arbitration clauses into contracts, drawing on ICSID membership, the New

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	resolution of disputes	York Convention and the Caribbean Court of Justice
Depth of the domestic financial sector	Local banks have limited capacity for large, long-term project finance, while public borrowing is rising to fund infrastructure	Use development finance and export-credit agencies, such as US EXIM's $527 million loan for the gas-to-energy project, alongside international banks; the IMF rates debt-distress risk as low

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Guyana offers growth on a scale few markets can match, backed by world-class offshore resources, a sovereign wealth fund and a debt ratio the IMF considers low risk. Its main considerations are manageable with planning. First, Venezuela's claim to the Essequibo region is now before the International Court of Justice, which held hearings in May 2026 and is expected to rule within months. Guyana's commitment to a legal resolution and its strong international partnerships support stability. Second, US-dollar access has tightened as the economy has expanded, and the invoice-verification rules introduced in September 2025 mean investors should plan currency conversion and repatriation timing with their banks from the outset. Third, local content rules and the capacity of the courts favour well-structured joint ventures and arbitration clauses. With the gas-to-energy project, new bridges and roads, and continued strong non-oil growth, these constraints are easing, and investors who build them into early planning are well placed to benefit from Guyana's expansion.

MARKET ACCESS

Guyana is a member of CARICOM and its Single Market and Economy, which gives preferential access across the Caribbean Community, and it has been a member of the WTO since 1995. Through CARIFORUM, it is a party to the Economic Partnership Agreement with the European Union. Crude oil dominates exports, with Europe, the United States and Panama among the leading destinations in 2025, while rice, sugar, gold and bauxite remain important non-oil exports. Guyana is also CARICOM's land bridge to South America: Lethem connects it by road to northern Brazil, and a bridge across the Corentyne River to Suriname is planned. As export volumes rise, investors are well placed to supply both the regional Caribbean market and the wider Atlantic basin.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President (Mohamed Irfaan Ali)	Sets national development priorities, including oil-revenue management, infrastructure and the Low Carbon Development Strategy; re-elected in September 2025	Primary reference point for Guyana's strategic direction and major projects
Guyana Office for Investment (GO-Invest)	National investment promotion agency that facilitates registration, incentives and investment agreements	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentive guidance
Ministry of Natural Resources (including the Local Content Secretariat)	Oversees petroleum licensing and the oil and gas sector, and administers local content compliance	Essential counterpart for any energy or oil-services engagement
Ministry of Finance	Leads the budget, public investment and borrowing, approves investment agreements and oversees the Natural Resource Fund	Key interlocutor on incentives, public-private partnerships and fiscal policy
Bank of Guyana	Central bank; manages the exchange rate, foreign-exchange allocation and banking supervision	Important for currency-conversion planning and banking-sector matters
ExxonMobil Guyana (Stabroek operator, with Chevron and CNOOC)	Operates the Stabroek Block and its successive production projects, which generate most national output growth	Principal gateway to oil and gas supply-chain opportunities

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Ministry of Foreign Affairs	Leads the Essequibo case before the ICJ and Guyana's international partnerships	Relevant for understanding the border case and diplomatic positioning

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Private Sector Commission and the Georgetown Chamber of Commerce and Industry are the principal domestic business bodies, and the American Chamber of Commerce in Guyana represents a growing international business community. GO-Invest runs investor outreach and sector promotion, and the annual Guyana Energy Conference and Supply Chain Expo in Georgetown is the main meeting point for energy and supply-chain businesses. The Stabroek operators run supplier-development programmes aligned with the Local Content Act, which are useful for finding partners. Multilateral and development lenders, including the Inter-American Development Bank, the World Bank, the Caribbean Development Bank and US EXIM, are active in infrastructure, energy and private-sector development, and they can co-finance projects.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Guyana suits investors who can move quickly into a fast-growing economy and who value long-term positioning. These include: oil services, engineering and logistics firms building local-content partnerships around the Stabroek projects; construction, materials and real-estate investors serving housing, hotels and public works; power, gas and industrial investors drawn to the gas-to-energy project and the planned Wales industrial area; and agribusiness and food-processing investors building on Guyana's land, water and CARICOM market access. Financial-services and healthcare providers also find room to grow in a market that is expanding fast. Investors with patient capital and experience of frontier markets, who can manage currency planning and local partnerships, are best placed to benefit.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage GO-Invest and confirm incentive terms
Open early dialogue with the investment agency to scope concessions under the Investment Act 2004 and prepare an investment agreement for approval by the Ministry of Finance.

STEP 2: Structure local partnerships for local content compliance
Identify Guyanese joint-venture partners and register with the Local Content Secretariat before bidding for oil and gas contracts.

STEP 3: Plan foreign-exchange and repatriation arrangements
Agree conversion procedures and lead times with banks, and document repatriation terms, so that dollar flows match project and dividend schedules.

STEP 4: Position around the non-oil build-out
Track the gas-to-energy project, the Wales industrial area, road and bridge programmes, and agricultural expansion for supply and investment openings.

STEP 5: Monitor the ICJ border ruling and secure contractual protections
Follow the Essequibo case, use arbitration clauses and consider political-risk insurance for projects in western regions.